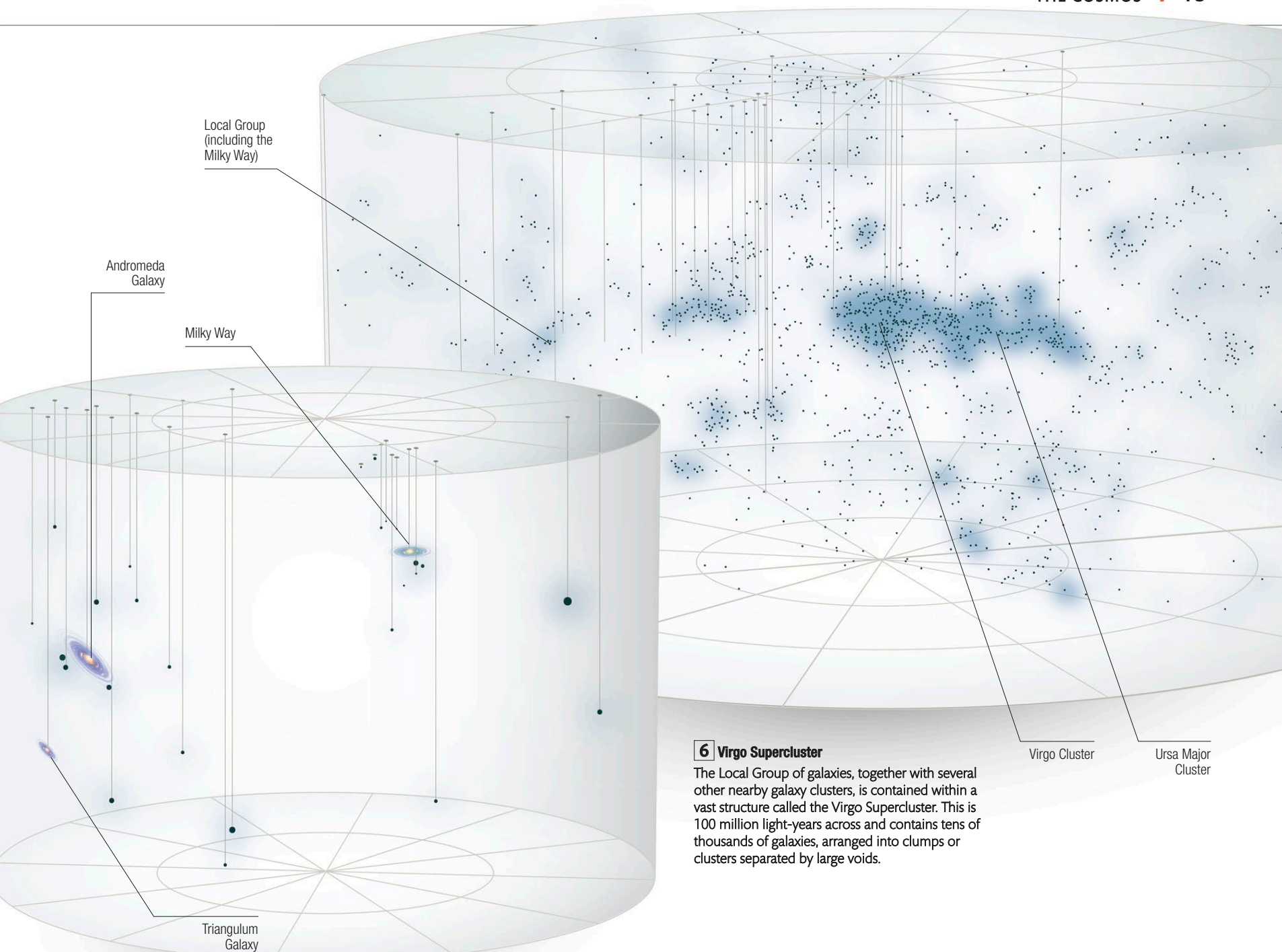


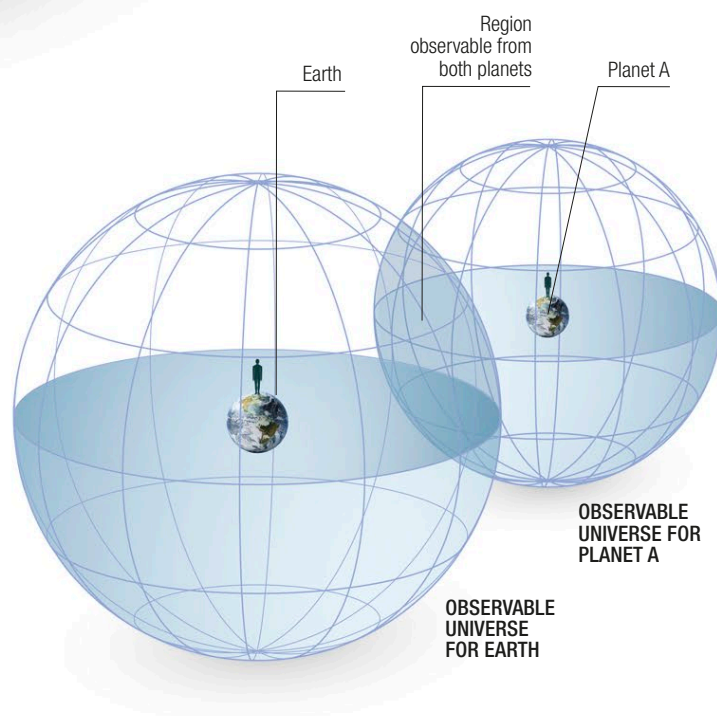


5 Local group

The Local Group is a cluster of galaxies consisting of the Milky Way, the Andromeda Galaxy (the nearest large spiral galaxy to the Milky Way), another spiral galaxy called Triangulum, and more than 50 other smaller galaxies. All occupy a region of space about 10 million light-years across.

6 Virgo Supercluster

The Local Group of galaxies, together with several other nearby galaxy clusters, is contained within a vast structure called the Virgo Supercluster. This is 100 million light-years across and contains tens of thousands of galaxies, arranged into clumps or clusters separated by large voids.



◀ The observable Universe

Although the Universe has no edges and may be infinite, the part visible to us is finite. Called the observable Universe, it is the region of space from which light has had time to reach us during the 13.8 billion years since the Big Bang. Physically it is a sphere about 93 billion light-years across, with Earth at the center. The inhabitants of a planet located outside our observable Universe (Planet A) would have a different observable Universe to us, though the two observable Universes might overlap.

Light from some of the most distant known galaxies has taken over **13 billion years**—most of the **age of the Universe**—to reach us